

MT8002 Elements of Set Theory

7. Ordered Sets

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Preliminaries

Textbook

Derek Goldrei (1996). Classic Set Theory. A Guided Independent Study.

Convention

The numbers and page numbers assigned to chapters, examples, exercises, figures, quotes, sections and theorems on these slides correspond to the numbers assigned in the textbook.

Outline

7.1 Introduction

7.2 Linearly Ordered Sets

References

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7.2 Linearly Ordered Sets

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Introduction

- We can use binary relations to order **some** (partial order) or **all** (linear order) the elements of a set.
- Orderings are binary relations that satisfy certain properties.
- Let X be a set. **Weak** orders $(\leq_X)$ and **strict** orders $(<_X)$ can be interchangeably defined.

Outline

7.1 Introduction

7.2 Linearly Ordered Sets

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Binary Relations

Definition (p. 164)

Let X be a set. A set R is a **binary relation on X** if $R \subseteq X \times X$.

Notation

Let R be a binary relation on a set X .

(a) We write $(x, y) \in R$ or xRy .

(b) We write $(x, y) \notin R$ or $x \not R y$.

Weak Orders

Definitions (p. 164)

Let $\leq_X$ be a binary relation on a set X . The relation $\leq_X$ is a **weak partial order** on the set X (or the set X is **weakly partially ordered** by the relation $\leq_X$), if it has the following properties:

- (a) **reflexive**: for all $x \in X$, $x \leq_X x$;
- (b) **anti-symmetric**: for all $x, y \in X$, if $x \leq_X y$ and $y \leq_X x$ then $x \doteq y$;
- (c) **transitive**: for all $x, y, z \in X$, if $x \leq_X y$ and $y \leq_X z$ then $x \leq_X z$.

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If additionally the relation $\leq_X$ has the following property:

- (d) **linear**: for all $x, y \in X$, $x \leq_X y$ or $y \leq_X x$,
- then the relation $\leq_X$ is a **weak linear order** on the set X (or the set X is **weakly linearly ordered** by the relation $\leq_X$).

Weak Orders

Examples (informal, p. 164)

The usual relations $\leq$ and $\geq$ on the sets $\mathbb{N}$, $\mathbb{Z}$, $\mathbb{Q}$ and $\mathbb{R}$ are weak linear orders on those sets.

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Let X be a set. The relation $\subseteq$ on $\mathcal{P}(X)$ is a weak partial order.

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Let X be a set. Is the relation $\subseteq$ on $\mathcal{P}(X)$ a weak linear order?

Answer

No! For example the relation $\subseteq$ on the power set of $\{a, b\}$ is not linear because $\{a\}, \{b\} \in \mathcal{P}(\{a, b\})$ but neither $\{a\} \subseteq \{b\}$ nor $\{b\} \subseteq \{a\}$.

Weak Orders

Description

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Definition (p. 164)

Let R be a weak partial order on a set X and let $A \subseteq X$. The **restriction** of the relation R to the set A , denoted $R|_{A \times A}$, is the relation defined by

$$R|_{A \times A} := \{ (a, b) \in R : a, b \in A \}.$$

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Theorem (Exercise 7.2)

Let R be a weak partial (respectively linear) order on a set X and let $A \subseteq X$. Show that $R|_{A \times A}$ is a partial (respectively linear) order on the set A .

Strict Orders

Definitions (p. 165)

Let $<_X$ be a binary relation on a set X . The relation $<_X$ is a **strict partial order** on X (or the set X is **strictly partially ordered** by the relation $<_X$) if it has the following properties:

- (a) **irreflexive**: for all $x \in X$, it is not the case that $x <_X x$;
- (b) **transitive**: for all $x, y, z \in X$, if $x <_X y$ and $y <_X z$ then $x <_X z$.

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If additionally the relation $<_X$ has the following property:

- (c) **linear**: for all $x, y \in X$, $x <_X y$ or $x \doteq y$ or $y <_X x$,
- then the relation $<_X$ is a **strict linear order** on the set X (or the set X is **strictly linearly ordered** by the relation $\leq_X$).

Strict Orders

Examples

The usual relations $<$ and $>$ on the sets $\mathbb{N}$, $\mathbb{Z}$, $\mathbb{Q}$ and $\mathbb{R}$ are strict linear orders on those sets.

Example

Let X be a set. The relation $\subset$ on $\mathcal{P}(X)$ is a strict partial order.

Strict Orders

Theorem (relationship between weak and strict partial orders, Exercise 7.4)

(a) Let $\leq_X$ be a weak partial order on a set X . The relation

$$x <_X y := x \leq_X y \text{ and } x \neq y$$

is a strict partial order on the set X .

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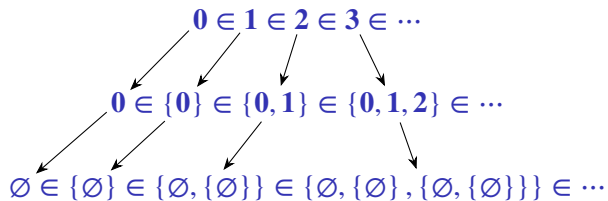
(b) Let $<_X$ be a strict partial order on a set X . The relation

$$x \leq_X y := x <_X y \text{ or } x \doteq y$$

is a weak partial order on the set X .

Orders on Natural Numbers

An “extra” property of natural numbers



Orders on Natural Numbers

Theorem 3.6

The set of natural numbers ω is strictly linearly ordered by the relation $\in$.

Orders on Natural Numbers

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The set of natural numbers ω is strictly linearly ordered by the relation $\in$.

That is, the relation $\in$ on ω has the following properties:

- (a) **irreflexive**: for all $n \in \omega$, $n \notin n$;
- (b) **transitive**: for all $m, n, p \in \omega$, if $m \in n$ and $n \in p$ then $m \in p$;
- (c) **linear**: for all $m, n \in \omega$, $m \in n$ or $m \doteq n$ or $n \in m$.

Orders on Natural Numbers

Example (p. 42)

Although the relation $\in$ is transitive on the set ω it does not mean that the relation is transitive on any set. For example, the relation is not transitive on the set

$$\{0, \{0\}, \{\{0\}\}\}$$

because $0 \in \{0\}$ and $\{0\} \in \{\{0\}\}$ but $0 \notin \{\{0\}\}$.

Orders on Natural Numbers

Definition (p. 41)

For all $\mathbf{m}, \mathbf{n} \in \omega$,

$\mathbf{m} < \mathbf{n} := \mathbf{m} \in \mathbf{n}$,

$\mathbf{m} \leq \mathbf{n} := \mathbf{m} < \mathbf{n}$ or $\mathbf{m} \doteq \mathbf{n}$.

Conventions

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An ordered set X by a relation R shall we denote by the pair (X, R) .

Order-Isomorphism

Description

We need a precise way to express when two ordered sets are “the same”.

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Definitions (p. 166)

Let $(X, <_X)$ and $(Y, <_Y)$ be two strictly partially ordered sets.

The sets are **order-isomorphic**, denoted $(X, <_X) \cong (Y, <_Y)$, if there is a **bijection** $f : X \longrightarrow Y$ such that for all $x_1, x_2 \in X$,

$$x_1 <_X x_2 \quad \text{if and only if} \quad f(x_1) <_Y f(x_2).$$

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$$x_1 <_X x_2 \quad \text{if and only if} \quad f(x_1) <_Y f(x_2).$$

The map f is an **order-isomorphism**.

Remark

The above definition on weakly partially ordered sets is similar.

Order-Isomorphism

Exercise (informal)

Let $<$ and $>$ be the usual orders on $\mathbb{Z}$. Show that $(\mathbb{Z}, <) \cong (\mathbb{Z}, >)$.

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Solution

Let $f : \mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ be the function $n \longmapsto -n$. We can show that the function f is a bijection and that it preserves the order, that is, for all $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}$,

$$m < n \quad \text{if and only if} \quad -m > -n.$$

Order-Isomorphism

Theorem (Exercise 7.6)

The relation $\cong$ is an equivalence relation on strictly partially ordered sets, i.e., the relation $\cong$ satisfies the following properties:

- (a) **reflexive**: for all X , $X \cong X$;
- (b) **symmetric**: for all X and Y , if $X \cong Y$ then $Y \cong X$;
- (c) **transitive**: for all X , Y and Z , if $X \cong Y$ and $Y \cong Z$ then $X \cong Z$.

Order-Isomorphism

Definition (p. 168)

An **order-theoretic invariant** is a property of an ordered set preserved under order-isomorphism.

Order-Embedding

Description

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Definition (p. 167)

Let $(X, <_X)$ and $(Y, <_Y)$ be two strictly partially ordered sets.

A function $f : X \longrightarrow Y$ is an **order-embedding** of $(X, <_X)$ into $(Y, <_Y)$ if f is **one-one** and, for all $x_1, x_2 \in X$,

$$x_1 <_X x_2 \quad \text{if and only if} \quad f(x_1) <_Y f(x_2).$$

Order-Embedding

Exercise (informal)

Let $<$ be the usual order on $\mathbb{N}$ and $\mathbb{R}$. Show an order-embedding of $(\mathbb{N}, <)$ into $(\mathbb{R}, <)$

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Solution

Let $f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be the function $n \mapsto n$. We can show that the function f is one-one and that it preserves the order, that is, for all $m, n \in \mathbb{N}$,

$$m > n \quad \text{if and only if} \quad f(m) > f(n).$$

Representation of Linearly Ordered Sets

“If $<_x$ is the order on X , and the elements x, x' of X are related by $x <_x x'$, we picture x to the left of x' . [...] Of course, we must not read too much into the picture. The picture is very suggestive of the usual real line, but for instance there might not be any elements of X between x and x' in the picture above; and indeed there might be no order-embedding from X into $\mathbb{R}$ with its usual order.” (p. 167)



Maximum and Minimum Elements

Definitions (p. 168)

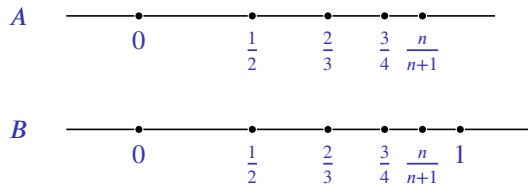
Let X be a set weakly linearly ordered by $\leq_X$ and let $a, b \in X$.

- (a) The element b is the **maximum** element of X , if $x \leq_X b$ for all $x \in X$.
- (b) The element a is the **minimum** element of X , if $a \leq_X x$ for all $x \in X$.

Maximum and Minimum Elements

Example (informal, p. 168)

Let $A = \left\{ 1 - \frac{1}{n+1} : n \in \mathbb{N} \right\}$ and $B = A \cup \{1\}$, subsets of $\mathbb{Q}$, with the usual order.



The set A has minimum element 0 , but no maximum element.

The set B has minimum element 0 , and maximum element, 1 .

Maximum and Minimum Elements

Remark

In the next theorem we shall see that the maximum and the minimum are order-theoretic invariants.

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Theorem 7.1

Let $f : X \longrightarrow Y$ be an order-isomorphism from $(X, \leq_X)$ to $(Y, \leq_Y)$.

- (a) If X has a maximum element then so does Y .
- (b) If X has a minimum element then so does Y .

Maximum and Minimum Elements

Example (informal)

Let $A = \left\{ 1 - \frac{1}{n+1} : n \in \mathbb{N} \right\}$ and $B = A \cup \{1\}$, subsets of $\mathbb{Q}$, with the usual order.

From Theorem 7.1 the ordered sets $(A, <)$ and $(B, <)$ are not order-isomorphic because the set B has maximum element, but the set A does not.

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Derek Goldrei (1996). Classic Set Theory. A Guided Independent Study. Chapman & Hall (cit. on p. 2).